

Bizfon Uses Avnet Design Services' Xilinx FPGA Engineering Service to Quickly Add New xDSL Features to its Bizfon 680 Telephone System

*Expanded internal engineering team with FPGA expertise and **cuts time-to-market***

There are more than nine million businesses in the United States today that employ between two and 25 people. An additional 850,000-plus new businesses are launched every year. To compete effectively, small companies must be as available and responsive to their customers, clients, and partners as their larger competitors. Bizfon develops solutions to meet the specific needs of real estate agencies, executive recruitment firms, churches and other small businesses and non-profit organizations. The engineers at Bizfon had plans for an xDSL feature upgrade for the newest phone system, the Bizfon 680. What they didn't have was a lot of time to do the detailed design work, to determine the trade offs, to implement the design in a Xilinx FPGA and to fully document the design. With time-to-market a critical factor and limited resources, they investigated third party FPGA design services. "We needed someone with a detailed knowledge and experience of our application area. We also needed someone with a solid background in FPGA design methodology, someone we had a high degree of confidence in," explained Mitch Kary, Director of Hardware Engineering for Bizfon.

The design for the PCM stream controller FPGA, the heart of the Bizfon 680, was critical to the project's success. "We had no room for failure in the design of the Bizfon 680 PCM stream controller FPGA. We needed someone we were confident in, someone who would be a part of our team," said Mitch. "After speaking to several design service providers, we selected Avnet

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*Mitch Kary, Director of
Hardware Engineering for Bizfon*

Design Services to do the detailed design work for the Bizfon 680 PCM stream controller FPGA. Their ability to quickly understand our design challenges enabled them to begin contributing to the design effort immediately. We were confident our project would be successful," explained Mitch.

"Avnet Design Services contributed through every step of the design process. They took our specification and proposed several design scenarios. Together we selected the best one for our application. Avnet Design Services then completed the specification, updating the design choices made along the way. The finished design was accompanied by a complete documentation set. As a result, planning for design support during manufacturing and market release was far easier."

The Bizfon 680 provides small businesses with a full-featured POTS based telephone system. It includes capabilities for built-in voice mail with eight individual mailboxes, automatic answering with professionally recorded greetings, automatically created directory, and two informational message mailboxes for recording such messages as directions to your office. The system also

permits call transfers to any extension. Meeting room conferencing automatically links up to five callers, in or out of the office, when they each dial the reserved meeting room extension number. Other features also include unique remote-user capabilities that allow you to use all of your Bizfon system's features from a remote telephone. Future revisions will include an xDSL interface and data routing capabilities.

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